



Parks Board August 16, 2022

Meeting Metadata	Details
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Muncie Parks and Recreation Board Meeting Summary

Meeting Date: August 16, 2022

Body: Muncie Parks and Recreation Board

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the regular Tuesday, August 16, 2022 Muncie Parks and Recreation Board meeting to order at [00:00:13](#).
- **Attendance:** Specific roll call names of individual board members were not explicitly verbalized at opening, but board members actively participating in discussions and voting included the presiding officer, Dr. Shannon Powers, and other commissioners. Staff present included Park Superintendent Karl Malone, Dustin Clark, and Nikki.

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer [00:00:17](#).
- **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes were approved via voice vote ([00:01:10](#) - "All in favor signify by saying I...").

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:17 Superintendent's Report (Urban Forestry, Parks Beautification, and Pools)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Karl Malone, Park Superintendent.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Superintendent Malone reported on urban forestry updates, noting that crews (Kelly and Chris) have been clearing fallen trees and debris, working with subcontractors on tree removals at McCollum Park (removing 40<U+2013>50 trees). He highlighted the recent partnership event at McCollum Park involving the City of Muncie, Kyle Petty Foundation, and Ball State. Softball field preparations are underway at Westside Park and Heekin Park for September games. Regarding Tuhey Pool, despite challenges with repairs (pumps, valves) and financing, the facility remained open for approximately 105 days. Security cameras have been installed at Tuhey Pool and Morningside Park, with future installations planned for Coulee, Heekin, and Thomas Parks.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal vote taken.
- **00:03:34 Project Updates: Riverview Splash Park, Halteman Pickleball, and Skate Park**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Karl Malone and Dustin Clark.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dustin Clark provided design illustrations for the Riverview Splash Park from Vortex, featuring interchangeable above-ground water features, a quarter-mile walking trail, shelter updates, a restroom facility, playground equipment, and an expanded parking area made possible by the mayor acquiring adjacent acreage. Halteman Park pickleball courts are scheduled to begin in early fall and finish in spring 2023. Westside Park skate park planning continues with community surveys and bond funding.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal vote taken.
- **00:26:27 Prairie Creek Reservoir & Victoria Brewer Construction Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dustin Clark.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Dustin Clark provided the Prairie Creek report, noting upcoming triathlon events (Caltri) and ongoing preparations for the Ironman event using the Horizon Convention Center for packet pickup and athlete intake. Prairie Creek has added two security SUVs (\$12,000 each) and a work truck. Victoria Brewer requested permission to continue non-permanent construction upstairs at Prairie Creek.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve Victoria Brewer's non-permanent construction passed via voice vote (**00:27:09** - "All in favor signify by saying I...").
- **00:29:19 Old Business: Rental Rates, Fee List, and Online Software**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Nikki / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed a proposed fee list and rental rates, specifically addressing missing pricing for 10x10 pop-up tents and large event tents. IT and staff are examining software options for online cabin and facility rentals to avoid duplicate service costs.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Table review for formal voting at next month's meeting [00:29:39](#).
 - [00:34:23](#) **New Business: Mayor Dan Rigney on City Bond Funding & Park Allocations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Mayor Dan Rigney.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Mayor Rigney announced that the City Council voted to approve a bond allocating \$900,000 toward parks (\$300,000 set aside for "Till Pond" / Till Pond project pending a DNR grant; \$600,000 distributed across multiple parks via the Muncie Redevelopment Commission). Allocations include: Tuhey Pool repairs (\$35,000), Skate Park (\$220,000 allocated toward engineering/construction), Ball Court Park earthwork/soccer repairs (\$20,000), Heekin Park (\$75,000), Coulee Park upgrades, Jacks Park major upgrades, Halteman pickleball, Anthony Park playground equipment (via an MOU with Ball State), and Morningside Park overruns (\$18,000).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no formal vote taken.
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4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- [00:51:11](#) **Wendell Beatty**
 - **Topics Addressed:** Addressed the board regarding reinstalling private docks behind his property in the cove near the reservoir. Noted he previously had a dock and maintained the property for 22 years.
 - **Board/Staff Response:** Dustin Clark and board members explained that private docks in non-public areas are currently on hold pending review by American Water's legal department regarding long-term lease compliance. No immediate approval can be granted until legal guidance is received from American Water.
 - [00:62:11](#) **Mark Kinman (Southside Neighborhood Association)**
 - **Topics Addressed:** Invited the community to the Southside Neighborhood Association Family Fun Night on Tuesday, August 23rd, from 6:00 PM to 8:00 PM at Coulee Park, featuring a mobile music van, free food, and splash pad access. Raised questions regarding event permitting, noise variances, and restroom access for the event.
 - **Board/Staff Response:** The board clarified that publicized public gatherings constitute an "event" requiring formal approval and facility request paperwork. The board addressed restroom access and advised coordinating with Nikki and Carl to finalize paperwork.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve the Southside Neighborhood Association event on August 23rd (pending completion of paperwork) passed unanimously by voice vote ([00:17:21](#)).
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5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**

- Dr. Shannon Powers announced she submitted a \$25,000 grant application to the Community Foundation for Tuhey Pool painting supplies, with a decision expected on September 20th.
- The next regular board meeting is scheduled for **September 20, 2022**.

- **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn the meeting was moved and seconded, closing the meeting by voice vote (00:18:48 - "So moved. Second. Junior adjourned.").

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